

Leave & Time-Off Policy

Leave types, requests, approvals, balances, emergency leave, and common employee questions

Knowledge-base note: This document is fictional sample company policy content created for the WorkMate AI RAG demonstration. Employees should follow the actual company's approved procedures where they differ.

1. Purpose

This policy explains how employees request leave, check leave information, handle emergencies, and track the status of leave requests.

2. Leave Types

Common leave categories include casual leave and sick leave. Additional leave categories may exist according to employment terms and company rules.

Employees should select the correct leave type when creating a request. If unsure, they should contact HR.

3. Casual Leave

Casual leave is intended for short personal needs and planned absences.

Employees should submit requests before the leave begins whenever reasonably possible.

Submitting a request does not mean the leave is automatically approved.

4. Sick Leave

Sick leave may be used when an employee cannot work because of illness.

If illness is unexpected, the employee should notify the manager or HR as soon as practical and submit the formal leave request when able.

Supporting documentation may be requested for longer or specific types of absence according to company procedure.

5. Leave Balance

Employees can ask WorkMate to check the leave balance available in the employee database when that information is supported.

WorkMate should distinguish between available balance and an already submitted leave request. A pending request may not reduce the final balance until processed according to the company's system.

6. How to Request Leave

A leave request should normally include the leave type, start date, end date or duration, and a short reason where required.

Employees should submit the request through the approved system or WorkMate-supported workflow.

A unique request ID may be generated so the employee can track the request later.

7. Leave Approval

Some leave requests require manager or HR approval.

Possible request statuses include Pending, Approved, Rejected, and Closed.

Employees should not assume approval until the system or authorized reviewer confirms it.

8. Rejected Leave

If a leave request is rejected, the employee should check the reason if one is provided and contact the manager or HR if clarification is needed.

An employee should not treat a rejected request as approved absence.

9. Emergency Leave

When an unexpected emergency prevents advance notice, the employee should notify the manager or HR as soon as practical.

The employee should complete the formal leave request after the immediate emergency has been handled.

10. Half-Day Leave

Where supported, employees may request a half-day or partial-day absence. The request should clearly identify the date and expected period of absence.

Employees should follow the attendance process for the working portion of the day.

11. Leave Cancellation

If approved leave is no longer required, the employee should request cancellation through the approved process and inform the manager when necessary.

Employees should not create duplicate requests to replace an existing request unless instructed.

12. Extending Leave

If an employee needs additional days after leave has already been approved, the employee should submit a new or modified request according to the company's procedure before the additional absence whenever possible.

An extension should not be assumed to be approved automatically.

13. Leave During WFH

WFH and leave are different arrangements. An employee should not use WFH as a substitute for leave unless the WFH request has been approved.

If an employee becomes sick while working from home, the employee should follow the normal sick-leave procedure.

14. Common Employee Questions

How many casual leaves do I have?

WorkMate can provide the stored leave balance when employee data is available. It should not invent a balance.

Can I take leave tomorrow?

The employee can submit a request, but approval depends on the authorized reviewer and applicable policy.

My leave request is pending. Can I take the leave?

The employee should follow the company's approval process and should not assume that pending means approved.

My leave was rejected. What can I do?

The employee can contact the manager or HR for clarification and follow any permitted resubmission process.

15. Leave and Attendance

Approved leave should be reflected according to the company's attendance process. If attendance still shows the employee as absent or working, the employee should report the mismatch to HR.

Employees should not alter attendance records themselves to hide an approved or unapproved absence.